Artists find different ways teacher and cover plan

GROW Spring 1 Week 1 Monday 4 January 2027 P6 Year A Explore

Teach one 40 minute lesson. Both pathways use Explore. Explore how artists express resilience and change.

Today: Explore two descriptions of artists' work, test an artistic idea and plan a first response.

Success criteria

I identify a detail in a description of an artist's work.

I test repetition or a change in my chosen art form.

I explain one choice for my own response.

Prepare before pupils arrive

For five pupils: five books or arts logs, five pencils and ten small test sheets if available.

Optional visual route: five sheets, six brushes including the adult model, a small amount of familiar non-toxic paint, five mats, three stable water pots and cloths.

Optional collage route: ten scrap sheets and three glue sticks. Tear paper instead of cutting; no pins.

Movement, original words or quiet finger taps need no art materials. A pupil may direct the adult.

Keep the original work or a dated observation note and the pupil's confirmed words for lesson two.

Set a clear stop signal and quiet option. Offer an invented feeling or abstract theme. Have the prior work or an honest catch-up trial ready for lesson two.

Timing

Arrival 0-3; Starter 3-6; I do 6-12; We do 12-18; Create 18-32; Review 32-37; Exit 37-40 minutes. Tidy in the final two minutes of Review.

Non specialist demonstration

0-15 seconds: Say: I want to show a seed growing after wind. Make four small grey zigzag marks, or four small sideways hand movements.

15-30 seconds: Say: I will repeat the movement, then change it. Add three green curves that grow taller, or move the hands slowly upwards.

30-45 seconds: Say: My last marks point up. That change suggests growth to me. Leave a pause and compare the first and last part.

45-60 seconds: Say: I can test another spacing or pace. I will choose the version that best fits my idea. This is our original example, not a copy of an artwork.

Teaching the first twelve minutes

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Arrival 0 to 3 minutes

Pupil task: Choose marks, sound, movement or words. You can work quietly and share privately.

What to say: You can use marks, sounds, movement or your own words. You can work quietly and show me privately. Our idea can be invented.

What good looks like: The pupil chooses or indicates a form and knows the stop signal and quiet option.

Materials free fallback: Point to or say an art form. Choose seated gestures or an original spoken description.

Starter 3 to 6 minutes

Pupil task: Repeat a small action. Change its size, pace or direction. What changed?

What to say: What stayed the same? What changed? Repetition means doing something again. We can change pace, size, direction or space.

What good looks like: The pupil notices one change or makes a simple repeat-and-change pattern.

Materials free fallback: Use silent finger movements or describe 'small, small, larger'.

I do 6 to 12 minutes

Pupil task: Listen to the artist descriptions. Find one detail in each. Watch the original seed example.

What to say: The description tells me that Matisse moved cut shapes while trying ideas. I think this method could help an artist adapt. That second statement is my interpretation. Thomas's work uses repeated marks. My seed will use repetition in a different design.

What good looks like: The pupil can point to or repeat a verified detail and hears the difference between a fact and a personal reading.

Materials free fallback: Read both cards aloud and model a silent repeat-and-change gesture. No image, internet or art materials are needed.

Check and response: Which is a detail from the description: 'Thomas used rings of colour' or 'Everyone must feel happy'? Expected: rings of colour.

Guided practice and making

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We do 12 to 18 minutes

Pupil task: Try two versions with a partner or adult. Which version fits your idea? Say why. Hinge: an idea is unclear. Should the artist copy, change one feature and test, or give up?

What to say: What can move or change? Try version one, pause, then try version two. Which version suggests your chosen idea, and why? You can disagree politely. An artist wants to keep the idea of growth but the first attempt is unclear. Should they A copy every shape from a famous work, B change one feature and try again, or C stop because art must be perfect? Explain your choice.

What good looks like: The pupil tests two versions and gives a reason linked to a feature, such as wider spacing, slower pace or an upward direction. The pupil selects B and links an adjustment to the idea. The teacher rereads and models one change if the pupil selects A or C.

Materials free fallback: Direct the adult's hand positions, or perform two seated gestures. Say the two versions if movement is uncomfortable. Choose A, B or C verbally or by pointing. Describe the first and last part of a planned gesture or sound pattern.

Check and response: If the pupil cannot explain B, model changing only spacing, then use a parallel hinge: 'A quiet sound idea feels too busy. Would fewer taps and a pause help test the idea?' Continue independently when the pupil identifies a purposeful change.

Create 18 to 32 minutes

Pupil task: Make a small first response about resilience or change. Use your own subject. Repeat a feature. Change one thing. You may pause or ask for help.

What to say: Use your own idea. Show something continuing through a change. You may use colour and shape, an original sound pattern, a short movement or your own words. Stop after a small first version.

What good looks like: The pupil makes or directs a first attempt with a clear repeated feature and a deliberate change. The work need not be neat or finished.

Materials free fallback: Create and repeat a short silent gesture sequence, or speak an original description. Adult records the action sequence and the pupil's stated choice.

Optional progression evidence

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Optional next level stretch

What to say: If you want the extra task, Use both artist cards. Note one fact about each artist. Say which method interests you. Give your reason. Set one skill to practise. You can draw, speak or write.

What good looks like: The pupil distinguishes description from personal view, compares rearrangement with repetition and explains a choice for future practice.

Materials free fallback: Adult asks the same prompts and records a dated note using the pupil's own words.

Retain: Keep both facts, your view and reason, and your skill goal. Say which card you used. An adult can write your words.

Additional evidence may support later work at the next level. It is optional and is not needed for this lesson's Explore success criteria. The owner must review any future level requirements.

Review and evidence

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Review 32 to 37 minutes

Pupil task: Share privately or with a partner. Explain one artist link. Add your choice to the arts log.

What to say: Which artist's method or idea helped you? What did you choose for your own work? What might you test next time? You can say 'This suggests ... to me'.

What good looks like: The log links an artist detail to a pupil choice and identifies one next test. The adult distinguishes the pupil's words from a staff observation.

Materials free fallback: Give an oral log. Adult retains a dated note of the artist detail, pupil choice and observed first attempt. If recording is unavailable, repeat the pattern with the adult and note it later.

Exit 37 to 40 minutes

Pupil task: Choose one part to keep and one thing to test next time.

What to say: Next time you will develop this first response. Which part will you keep? What is one thing you might adjust? A pause or help can be part of the plan.

What good looks like: The pupil identifies one feature to retain or change. Materials are put away calmly.

Materials free fallback: Agree a short spoken cue to remember the sequence. Adult records its ordered steps and next test.

Store and log

Use the final two minutes of Review for quiet tidy-up. Keep paintings flat to dry, cap wet materials and wipe mats. Sound and movement pupils retain a simple sequence plan or dated adult observation plus their words. Work-only images are optional. Store the actual first attempt and log together.

Cover teacher route

Read the two short artist cards aloud. Ask pupils to repeat and change a silent hand movement. Model the seed example using words and gestures. Pupils make their own repeat-and-change response, explain one artist link and complete an oral or written log. Use the seven-stage timings. No artwork display or internet is required. Reserve the final two minutes of Review for quiet tidy-up and safe storage. If the previous response is missing, make a fresh short trial and record today's actual date.

Access and teaching decisions

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Adaptations and prompt ladder

Cognition and Learning: Show one instruction at a time. Model a small test, offer two choices, then fade the prompt. Read the artist description aloud when needed.

Communication and Interaction: Allow pointing, signing, speech or an adult scribe. Give processing time. Use I chose ___ because ___. Read scribed words back for correction.

SEMH: Use a fictional feeling or abstract idea. Let pupils choose form and audience. Offer a calm pause and agreed return cue. Public performance and personal disclosure are optional.

Sensory and Physical: Offer silent seated movements, large marks and pupil-directed adult handling. Keep sound below talking volume. Stop on a raised hand. Ask before touching work.

EAL: Plan in any language. Teach words through marks and gestures. Accept a labelled sketch or oral explanation. Check meaning before spelling.

1. Point to the place or instruction.
2. Ask a short question.
3. Rephrase the instruction.
4. Provide a scaffold or choice.
5. Model the first step only, then return the task.

Common mistakes and fixes

Everyone reads a colour or sound in the same way. - Colours and sounds can suggest different feelings to different people. A reasoned personal reading is valid.

Resilience means doing the same thing until it works. - An artist can change a method, take a break or ask for help. A purposeful adjustment counts.

A response must copy the artist's work. - Borrow an idea such as repetition or rearrangement, then make your own subject and design. Do not recreate an existing composition.

We know an artist's feelings just by describing a work. - Separate verified information from interpretation. Say 'This suggests ... to me' rather than claiming to know a private feeling.

Feedback

Give one specific success and one next step. VF verbal feedback; WS worked with support; I independent; NS next step; // self-edit; ? read this back; E evidence retained; R responded. Use R only when pupil voice and an audience are present, one NS is set, and the pupil responds in the same colour, on the same page or usual mode. A saved image alone is not R.

Where this leads

Artists, designers and performers test ideas and explain their choices. These skills help when working to a brief.